



EDUCATION ABROAD PROGRAM

Emergency Action Planning

This resource is designed to help education abroad offices and institutions create an emergency action plan specific to their needs. It is important to involve key stakeholders in planning response to any emergency that may occur abroad and consider all potential outcomes to respond and manage impact on students, community partners, the education abroad program, and the institution. All EAPs should be reviewed with your institutional risk manager and endorsed by institutional leadership for implementation.

Emergency Action Plans (EAP) are comprehensive guides that:

- Are built on core values
- Define the goal(s)
- Identify all parts: stakeholders and resources
- Have established and rehearsed protocols

TYPES OF EMERGENCIES

It is important to define what constitutes an emergency. Adapt the table below to create an emergency response protocol based on the type of emergency that occurs. Use column three to create a list of stakeholders to involve in the response. Then, create a detailed response plan for each level of emergency.

Seriousness	Description	Who Will Be Involved?
Level 1	Life and death. Student, or students, faces serious injury, fatal incident, incarceration, missing student or students, or significant disruption of the program as a result of the incident.	
Level 2	Significant illness or injury requiring hospitalization, but not life threatening. Minor damage to public/private property. Non-life-threatening sexual assault or harassment. Student, or students, faces disruption to their experience, but it does not disrupt the program.	
Level 3	Minor illness or injury to student or students. Minor property damage. Violation of student conduct. Immigration issue. No significant disruption to student experience.	
Level 4	Violation of student conduct that does not disrupt other student experience. Housing reassignment. Missing luggage or property. Minor illness or injury that does not require hospitalization.	

RESOURCES FOR EAP

Consider these prompts to determine your available resources for responding to an emergency.

1. Insurance Coverage

a. Who is our provider?

b. Who is the holder of the insurance policy at the institution?

c. What does our insurance cover when it comes to education abroad?

d. Are there gaps in coverage?

e. How do students, faculty, and staff access insurance coverage, claims, and information?

2. On-site Resources

a. Who is our main contact for each education abroad program?

b. What are the responsibilities of the on-site education abroad partner (refer to the Memorandum of Agreement)?

c. What physical and mental health services are available? Can they be accessed?

d. Where is the nearest U.S. Embassy and contact information?

e. Are there evacuation services available?

3. Communication

a. Is there a single point of contact established between the following parties? Who is that person and is their contact information easily accessible?

i. On-site and home institution

ii. Home institution and insurance provider

iii. Education abroad office and institutional leadership

iv. Home institution and parents

v. Home institution and media (if needed)

b. What is the protocol for communicating emergency information?

4. Practice and Evaluation

a. Have you rehearsed the Emergency Action Plan with key responsible parties?

b. How often is the Emergency Action Plan rehearsed?

c. How often is the Emergency Action Plan evaluated and improved?

LIFE CYCLE OF AN EAP



NEED MORE SUPPORT?

[Forum Consultants](#) are available to:

- Review and help improve your emergency action plans and protocols
- Rehearse your EAP
- Help design effective emergency communications
- Conduct crisis debriefs and assess past crisis response efforts
- Conduct a comprehensive health and safety review